WUM Advisory Services

Cover Letter

Dated: 20-Apr-26

CLIMATE-RESILIENT SCHOOL INFRASTRUCTURE TOOLKIT (CRIT)

The Selection Committee,
UNICEF Climate Ventures
2026 Selection Committee

United Nations Children's Fund
(UNICEF)

Subject: Proposal Submission for UNICEF Climate Ventures 2026 Grant Application

Dear Members of the Selection Committee,

WUM Advisory Services (SMC-Private) Limited is pleased to submit this proposal for consideration under the UNICEF Climate Ventures 2026 funding window. We respectfully present the **Climate-Resilient School Infrastructure Toolkit (CRIT)** as a practical, scalable, and child-centered innovation designed to protect children's learning environments in Pakistan's most climate-vulnerable regions.

Pakistan is facing an escalating climate emergency that directly threatens children's safety, health, and right to education. Recurrent floods, intensifying heatwaves, drought conditions, and deteriorating water systems continue to damage school infrastructure and disrupt learning continuity. These climate shocks disproportionately affect girls, children with disabilities, and children in low-income and rural communities, where recovery capacity remains weakest. In this context, strengthening school infrastructure is not only an adaptation priority, but also a child protection and education equity imperative.

CRIT is designed to respond to this urgent need by enabling communities to implement low-cost, locally sourced, and replicable resilience retrofits that reduce climate-related disruptions and safeguard children. The toolkit integrates hazard mapping, inclusive retrofitting guidance, community-based preparedness training, and real-time climate monitoring through low-cost

digital tools. It is engineered for high usability at school and district levels, ensuring that resilience interventions can be adopted beyond the pilot phase and embedded within provincial education systems.

WUM Advisory Services is a legally registered, women-led advisory and implementation entity committed to advancing climate resilience, education systems strengthening, inclusive development, and evidence-based policy engagement. Our organizational model is rooted in locally grounded delivery, strong fiduciary management, safeguarding compliance, and a commitment to open source innovation. We are positioned to mobilize CRIT rapidly through our technical expertise, field coordination networks, and structured programme management capacity.

The CRIT programme is fully aligned with UNICEF Climate Ventures priorities, particularly in the following areas:

- **Child-centered climate adaptation and resilience building** through safer learning environments and reduced disruption of education.
- **Climate and health integration**, including heat stress reduction, safe water measures, and disaster preparedness.
- **Open source and scalable solutions**, ensuring that CRIT is released as a Digital Public Good to support replication.
- **Gender equality and disability inclusion**, through girl-friendly WASH upgrades, safety design features, and universal accessibility retrofits.
- **Evidence generation and policy integration**, enabling government adoption through validated implementation models and structured technical guidance.

Through a 12-month pilot across high-risk districts in Sindh, Punjab, and Balochistan, CRIT will retrofit 50 schools, train 1,000 stakeholders, deploy climate monitoring tools, publish the open source toolkit, and generate actionable evidence to support provincial scale-up.

We are requesting **USD 93,500**, which remains within the UNICEF Climate Ventures maximum funding threshold. This investment will enable WUM Advisory Services to deliver a high-impact, value-for-money solution that protects children, strengthens local ownership, and provides a nationally scalable infrastructure resilience model for Pakistan and other climate-vulnerable contexts.

We sincerely appreciate UNICEF's leadership in advancing climate innovation for children and would be honored to partner with UNICEF Climate Ventures 2026 in implementing CRIT. We remain available to provide any additional information, clarifications, or documentation required to support the review process.

In Solidarity and Commitment to Change,

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